



MARKET MONITOR

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No. 82 – October 2020

Even though weather conditions have not been very favourable to maize crops in Europe, world maize output is still expected to exceed the high 2019 level, reaching a new record. Meanwhile, the estimate for this year's global wheat production has been raised since the previous report to also an all-time high, mostly on improved yield prospects in many countries. As for rice, the latest figures confirm expectations of larger plantings translating into an annual production recovery this season to a fresh historical peak. In the case of soybeans, the prospective rebound of global 2020/21 production is confirmed, despite some recent downward corrections due to weather issues.

Markets at a glance

	From previous forecast	From previous season
Wheat	▲	▼
Maize	▼	■
Rice	▲	■
Soybeans	▲	■

▲ Easing ■ Neutral ▼ Tightening

The **Market Monitor** is a product of the Agricultural Market Information System (AMIS). It covers international markets for wheat, maize, rice and soybeans, giving a synopsis of major market developments and the policy and other market drivers behind them. The analysis is a collective assessment of the market situation and outlook by the ten international organizations and entities that form the AMIS Secretariat.

Feature article

The State of Agricultural Commodity Markets 2020: Making trade and markets work for sustainable development

Over the past twenty years, international trade in food and agriculture has more than doubled in real value to amount to USD 1.5 trillion in 2018. Emerging economies and developing countries are increasingly participating in global agricultural and food markets; their exports have grown to more than one-third of the world total. At the same time, the composition of agri-food trade is changing. Driven by economic growth and associated lifestyle changes in many developing countries, trade in animal products, fruits and vegetables and processed food is gaining in relative importance.

Economic growth, lower trade barriers and improvements in transport and communication have also underpinned the evolution of global value chains (GVCs). About one-third of trade in food and agriculture takes place within GVCs and crosses borders at least twice, as primary commodities are initially exported to be processed into food products, which, in turn, are re-exported.

GVCs foster trade linkages that act as channels of technology and knowledge diffusion. Participation in GVCs can increase productivity at the farm and promote income growth. At the same time, GVCs support closer links between various actors compared with other forms of trade. In this way, value chains that are coherent with sustainability standards can help generate economic, environmental and social benefits.

Since the financial crisis in 2008 and the recession that followed, the slowdown of the global economy, and especially in emerging economies, has affected trade and GVCs. The COVID-19 outbreak and the restrictions on people's movements to contain it once again posed significant challenges to both domestic and global agricultural markets. Although agri-food

trade and value chains continued to function relatively smoothly, the medium-term impacts are expected to further rein in economic growth and market development. Efforts to minimize the disruption of GVCs and promote agricultural and food trade can generate both short- and long-term benefits.

Effective policies are particularly needed to support smallholder farmers. These include promoting skills development, investing in infrastructure (including digital infrastructure), and partnering with the private sector to foster technology adoption. Innovative business models to engage with smallholder farmers, including those related to contract farming and sustainability certification schemes, can play a significant role and transform the private sector into an agent for economic inclusion.

Against this background, digital technologies are rapidly transforming all stages of the value chain. A myriad of technology applications promote access to information, market participation, financial inclusion, food quality and safety, and sustainable practices. At the same time, digital technologies also entail challenges. This points to the necessity for enhanced collaboration between all stakeholders and for identifying best practices that can shape a regulatory framework which will maximize the benefits of digital technology for food and agriculture and minimize the associated risks.

FAO. 2020. *The State of Agricultural Commodity Markets 2020. Agricultural markets and sustainable development: Global value chains, smallholder farmers and digital innovations*. Rome, FAO.
<https://doi.org/10.4060/cb0665en>

World supply-demand outlook

- **Wheat** production forecast for 2020 now points to a new record following this month's upward revisions in Australia, the EU, and the Russian Federation.
- Utilization in 2020/21 expected to grow at slightly faster pace than projected earlier, supported by stronger feed use in China.
- Trade in 2020/21 (July/June) scaled up m/m on more brisk import demand, especially by China and Egypt.
- Stocks (ending in 2021) lifted by almost 3 million tonnes following this month's upwards revisions in the EU, the Russian Federation, and Ukraine.

- **Maize*** 2020 production forecast cut by 11.3 million tonnes (1.0 percent) m/m on less favourable prospects, mostly in Europe.
- Utilization in 2020/21 lowered on weaker growth of feed and industrial use, especially in the EU and the US, but still 28.0 million tonnes (2.5 percent) above last year's level.
- Trade forecast for 2020/21 (July/June) scaled up, reflecting stronger import demand in the EU along with a faster pace in shipments from the US.
- Stocks (ending 2021) forecast to remain near opening levels following a 9.8 million tonne cut m/m mainly on downward revisions to US opening stocks, as well as reductions to EU and China stocks.

- **Rice** production in 2020 unchanged m/m, as an upward revision for India, in particular, is offset by various downgrades, the most significant of which concerning Thailand.
- Utilization in 2020/21 still seen expanding by 1.5 percent y/y to a fresh peak, despite a slight downward revision largely attributable to lower anticipated uses in Indonesia.
- Trade in 2021 unchanged m/m, as downscaled export prospects for Pakistan, Thailand and Viet Nam are compensated by an upgrade to Indian shipments to a record high.
- Stocks (2020/21 carry-out) lifted somewhat on higher anticipated carry-overs in the major exporters (India, in particular); as a result, closing stocks are now seen essentially on par with their opening levels.

- **Soybean** 2020/21 production lowered from last month, with reduced forecasts for the US and Argentina outweighing an upward revision for Brazil, while global output would still be record-high.
- Utilization in 2020/21 trimmed somewhat, with downward adjustments for Argentina and the EU largely offset by higher forecasts for the US and several other countries; global consumption now forecast to grow by nearly 4 percent y/y.
- Trade in 2020/21 (Oct/Sept) slightly higher compared to September, as import forecasts are lifted for China and a couple of other countries, while shipments are raised primarily for Brazil.
- Inventories (2020/21 carry-out) scaled up, mainly reflecting higher forecasts for China, Argentina and Brazil, which overshadow a downward revision for the US.

Wheat	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC		
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast		2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	
	3 Sep	8 Oct		11 Sep		24 Sep		
Stocks	Prod	761.6	760.1	764.9	764.0	770.5	762.2	763.4
	Supply	628.1	626.1	630.9	630.4	634.5	628.7	628.4
	Utiliz.	1,032.7	1,036.6	1,039.7	1,048.0	1,070.3	1,023.9	1,042.6
	Trade	783.7	774.9	777.9	782.6	782.6	771.7	778.7
	Stocks	750.8	756.1	756.6	748.2	750.9	744.7	748.8
		625.3	628.7	626.7	622.2	620.9	615.9	616.8
		184.2	181.5	184.5	191.1	189.1	184.9	182.9
		179.0	177.0	177.5	185.8	182.1	178.1	175.9
		274.7	282.2	284.8	299.8	319.4	279.2	293.8
		147.0	143.6	146.2	148.1	155.7	149.1	155.0
Maize	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC		
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast		2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	
	3 Sep	8 Oct		11 Sep		24 Sep		
	Prod	1,138.0	1,182.1	1,170.8	1,112.8	1,162.4	1,121.1	1,160.4
	Supply	877.2	921.1	910.8	852.1	902.4	860.3	902.4
	Utiliz.	1,498.5	1,544.5	1,527.4	1,433.8	1,471.5	1,445.5	1,460.9
	Trade	1,039.5	1,082.7	1,066.5	962.3	1,010.5	980.2	1,011.5
	Stocks	1,139.7	1,173.4	1,167.7	1,124.2	1,164.7	1,145.0	1,176.2
		874.4	901.2	893.9	847.2	885.7	864.2	889.1
		172.0	173.5	176.0	175.2	185.0	173.3	178.0
	166.7	166.3	168.8	168.2	178.0	166.3	171.0	
	356.6	366.4	356.6	309.2	306.8	300.5	284.7	
	155.7	169.9	162.5	108.1	117.8	109.0	115.3	
Rice	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC		
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast		2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	
	3 Sep	8 Oct		11 Sep		24 Sep		
	Prod	501.3	509.2	509.1	495.9	500.1	497.1	504.0
	Supply	357.7	365.0	364.9	349.2	353.1	350.4	356.4
	Utiliz.	685.9	692.3	691.4	672.8	681.7	672.2	679.3
	Trade	437.0	444.7	443.8	411.1	418.2	416.9	422.3
	Stocks	502.8	511.0	510.5	491.1	496.5	496.9	499.8
		357.0	364.0	363.5	346.1	350.2	351.5	353.5
		44.0	47.1	47.1	43.0	44.4	42.0	44.8
	41.3	44.6	44.5	40.7	42.2	39.6	42.5	
	182.4	181.2	182.0	181.7	185.2	175.3	179.5	
	79.0	80.9	81.7	65.2	68.7	63.0	66.6	
Soybeans	FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC		
	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast		2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	2019/20 est	2020/21 f'cast	
	3 Sep	8 Oct		11 Sep		24 Sep		
	Prod	339.3	374.9	370.8	337.3	369.7	338.3	372.5
	Supply	321.2	356.3	352.0	319.2	352.2	320.1	353.7
	Utiliz.	402.6	425.6	428.3	450.4	465.7	400.4	419.4
	Trade	373.5	390.2	390.3	412.8	421.0	263.5	274.2
	Stocks	356.0	370.3	369.5	307.8	369.1	353.5	369.4
		248.3	255.6	255.0	217.3	252.7	244.3	253.6
		165.1	163.7	165.8	165.9	166.3	164.2	165.3
	67.1	66.2	67.4	65.5	64.3	67.3	65.6	
	57.8	53.0	58.0	96.0	93.6	46.9	50.0	
	38.6	35.0	36.2	68.8	66.3	19.3	20.8	

in million tonnes

i Data shown in the second rows refer to world aggregates without China; world trade data refer to exports and world trade without China excludes exports to China.

To review and compare data, by country and commodity, across three main sources, go to <https://app.amis-outlook.org/#/market-database/view-and-compare>

Estimates and forecasts may differ across sources for many reasons, including different methodologies.

* The 2020/21 AMIS-FAO world maize production forecast includes southern hemisphere maize crops harvested in 2020 whereas IGC and USDA include southern hemisphere maize crops to be harvested in 2021 in their 2020/21 world production numbers.

For more information see Explanatory notes on the last page of this report.

Revisions (FAO-AMIS) to 2020/21 forecasts since the previous report

in thousand tonnes

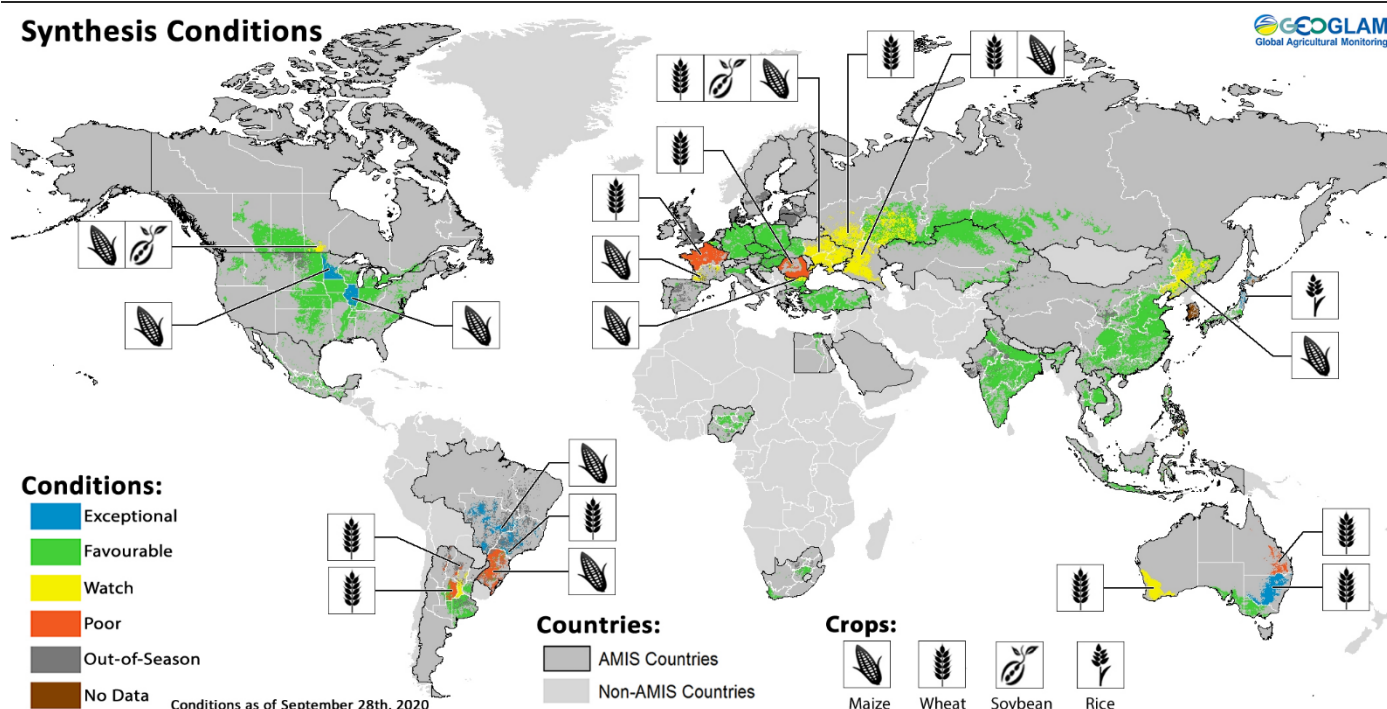
	WHEAT					MAIZE				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	4857	3000	470	3000	2543	-11272	2535	-5741	2500	-9829
Total AMIS	4857	3000	720	3000	2493	-10991	2450	-5532	2500	-9877
Argentina	-300	-	-	-	-300	-	-	-	-	-
Australia	2236	-	-229	1000	-653	-	-	-15	-	-
Brazil	-18	-	-668	-	650	361	-300	61	-	-
Canada	-755	-	-828	500	-800	279	-	279	-	-
China Mainland	-	2500	2500	-	-	-1000	-	1600	-	-2500
Egypt	-	500	-	-	-	-	500	500	-	-
EU	2194	-	445	500	1500	-7097	2250	-2277	-100	-2500
India	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Indonesia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Japan	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Kazakhstan	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Mexico	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Nigeria	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Philippines	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Rep. of Korea	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Russian Fed.	1000	-	-500	500	1000	-1000	-	-600	-400	-
Saudi Arabia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
South Africa	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Thailand	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Turkey	-	-	-	500	200	-	-	-	-	-
Ukraine	500	-	-	-	500	-1000	-	-	-1000	-
UK	-	-	-	-	396	-	-	-	-	30
US	-	-	-	-	-	-1534	-	-5080	4000	-4907
Viet Nam	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

	RICE					SOYBEANS				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	-143	-80	-496	-60	761	-4135	2194	-761	2108	5027
Total AMIS	-38	-150	-806	10	128	-4635	2144	-869	1608	4860
Argentina	-	-	10	-	-	-3000	400	-2100	-200	2700
Australia	-	-50	5	-	-15	-	-	-	-	-
Brazil	2	-	-8	-	10	1500	-50	293	2300	1700
Canada	-	-	-	-	-	285	-100	114	100	15
China Mainland	-	-	-	-	-	180	1000	-220	-	3800
Egypt	-455	-	-140	-	-300	-	200	100	-	150
EU	-	-	-	-	-	-35	-400	-627	-8	400
India	2250	-	50	1200	900	200	-150	-300	250	600
Indonesia	-	-200	-700	-	-300	-	210	137	3	100
Japan	-	-	-	-	-	-	114	166	-	-182
Kazakhstan	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Mexico	-	50	10	-	10	-	-	-	-	-
Nigeria	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Philippines	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Rep. of Korea	-119	-	-39	-	-60	-	-	10	-	-10
Russian Fed.	-	-	30	-30	10	-250	100	418	-200	-368
Saudi Arabia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
South Africa	-	-	-	-	-	-139	220	49	-	-230
Thailand	-1933	-	-163	-960	-400	-	300	360	-	90
Turkey	-	-	-	-	-	-	300	360	-	170
Ukraine	-	-	-	-	-	-756	-	-89	-637	-5
UK	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
US	218	50	65	-	48	-2620	-	460	-	-4070
Viet Nam	-	-	75	-200	225	-	-	-	-	-

Crop monitor

Crop conditions in AMIS countries (as of 28 September)

Synthesis Conditions



Crop condition map synthesizing information for all four AMIS crops as of 28 September. Crop conditions over the main growing areas for wheat, maize, rice, and soybean are based on a combination of national and regional crop analyst inputs along with earth observation data. **Only crops that are in other-than-favourable conditions are displayed on the map with their crop symbol.**

Conditions at a glance

Wheat - In the northern hemisphere, spring wheat continues to be harvested under favourable conditions. Sowing of winter wheat is underway with some issues in the EU, Ukraine, and the Russian Federation due to drought. In the southern hemisphere, dryness and frosts are affecting Argentina, while Australia is having a predominantly good season with the exception of Queensland.

Maize - In the southern hemisphere, Brazil is wrapping up the harvest of the summer-planted crop (larger season) while Argentina is sowing the spring-planted

crop. In the northern hemisphere, harvesting is underway with some mixed conditions in parts of the EU, Ukraine, the Russian Federation and China.

Rice – In China, both single-season and late-season rice are being harvested. In India, harvest is beginning for Kharif rice in the northern states. In Southeast Asia, conditions are favourable for both wet-season rice in the northern countries and dry-season rice in Indonesia.

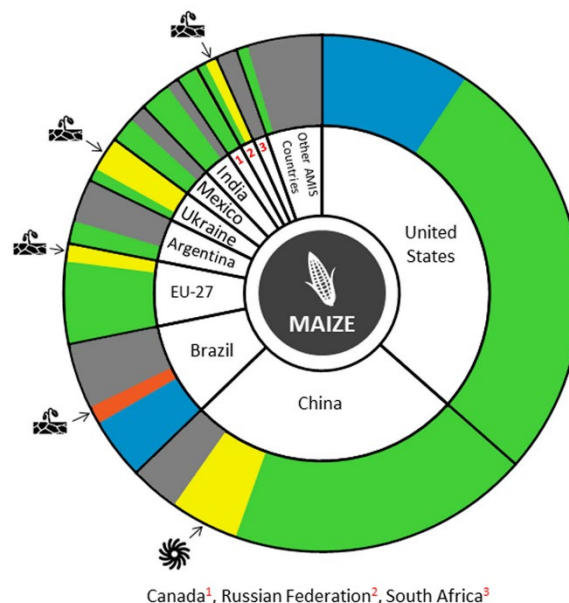
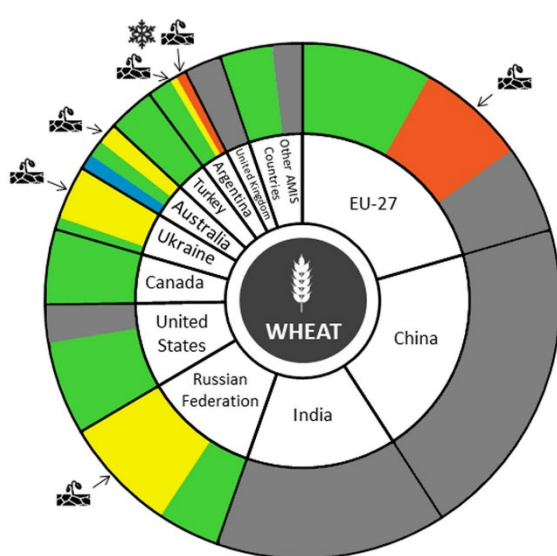
Soybeans - In the northern hemisphere, harvesting is beginning under generally favourable conditions with some small areas of concern in Ukraine and Canada.

La Niña advisory

The El Niño-Southern Oscillation (ENSO) is currently in the La Niña phase. La Niña conditions are expected to continue from October to February (~75 percent chance) and potentially through February to April (~50 percent chance).

La Niña conditions typically reduce October to February/May rainfall in East Africa, the southern US, the northern Middle East, and southern Central Asia. Southern Brazil, northern Argentina, eastern China, the Korean Peninsula, and southern Japan typically see reduced rainfall into January. La Niña conditions typically increase October to February/May rainfall in Southeast Asia, Southern Africa, southern Central America, northern South America, and in southernmost India and Sri Lanka. Australia and Indonesia typically see increased rainfall into December.

Additionally, a negative Indian Ocean Dipole may be at the beginning stage. A negative Indian Ocean Dipole typically reduces rainfall in East Africa and increases rainfall in parts of southern and central Australia.

Conditions:**Drivers:****Wheat**

In the **EU**, winter wheat sowing has begun under generally favourable conditions except for France and Romania where dryness from the summer persists. In **Ukraine**, sowing of winter wheat is beginning under mixed conditions due to drought across much of the country, which is delaying sowing for much of the crop. In the **Russian Federation**, spring wheat harvesting is wrapping up under favourable conditions. Winter wheat sowing is progressing under dry conditions, particularly in the south, which is hampering emergence and more rainfall is needed before winter dormancy. In the **US**, sowing of winter wheat is ongoing under favourable conditions. In **Canada**, spring wheat harvest is progressing under favourable conditions with slightly above-average yields expected. In **Argentina**, conditions are mixed, with recent rainfall in the south improving conditions. However, in the north and west regions, crop conditions are poor and mostly irreversible due to prolonged dryness throughout the season. In **Australia**, conditions are generally favourable except for Queensland which experienced persistent dryness and Western Australia following a dry September. By contrast, New South Wales is showing exceptional conditions with an expansion of sown area.

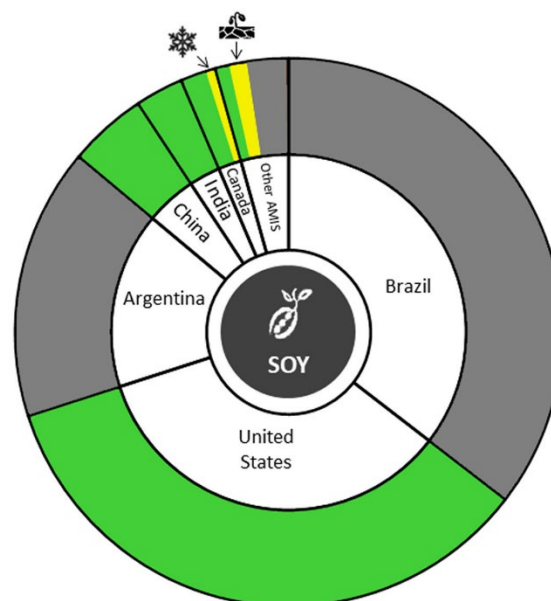
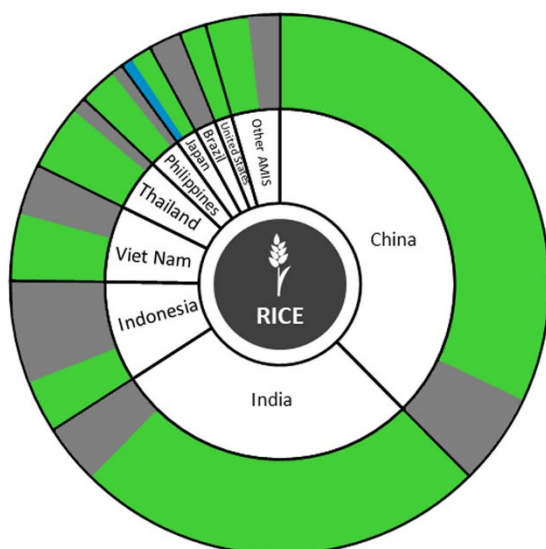
Maize

In **Brazil**, harvest of the summer-planted crop is wrapping up under exceptional conditions in the Central-West and Southeast regions while under poor conditions in the South region due to prolonged drought. In the **US**, harvesting is beginning under favourable to exceptional conditions with the highest yields in Minnesota and Illinois. In **Canada**, conditions are favourable across much of the country as harvest begins; however, recent frosts in southwestern Manitoba may impact yields and crop quality. In **Mexico**, sowing is wrapping up for the spring-summer crop under favourable conditions. In the **EU**, conditions are generally favourable, except for France, Bulgaria, and Lithuania where prolonged dryness has reduced expected yields. In **Ukraine**, harvesting is beginning under mixed conditions due to the severe summer drought in the central and southern regions. In the **Russian Federation**, harvesting is ongoing under mixed conditions due to dryness in the south during the flowering and early grain filling stages. In **China**, conditions are generally favourable for harvesting of spring and summer planted crops with some possible concerns in the Northeast region due to storm damage. In **India**, harvesting of Kharif maize has begun under favourable conditions with an increase in sown area compared to average and last year's levels. In **Argentina**, sowing is beginning for the spring-planted crop under favourable conditions with recent rains raising the pace.



Pie chart description: Each slice represents a country's share of total AMIS production (5-year average), with the main producing countries (95 percent of production) shown individually and the remaining 5 percent grouped into the "Other AMIS Countries" category. Sections within each country are weighted by the sub-national production statistics (5-year average) of the respective country and accounts for multiple cropping seasons (i.e. spring and winter wheat).

The late vegetative through to reproductive crop growth stages are generally the most sensitive periods for crop development.

Conditions:**Drivers:****Rice**

In **China**, conditions are favourable as harvesting of single-season rice continues and harvesting of late-season rice begins. In **India**, conditions are favourable for Kharif rice beginning to be harvested in the northern states. Sown area is above the average and last year's levels. In **Indonesia**, sowing of dry-season rice continues past the normal window due to below-normal rainfall earlier in the season. However, with the recent recovery of irrigation waters, conditions are now favourable as the harvesting of earlier sown crops continues. In **Viet Nam**, conditions are favourable in the south for the harvest of summer-autumn (wet-season) rice and the continued development of the autumn-winter (wet-season) crop. In the north, summer-autumn (wet-season) rice is under favourable conditions with ample rainfall. In **Thailand**, conditions are favourable for wet-season rice in the vegetative to reproductive stage with abundant rainfall supporting growth. In the **Philippines**, wet-season rice is under favourable conditions with crops sown from July-August in the tillering stage. In **Japan**, conditions are generally favourable across most of the country with exceptional conditions in the north. In the **US**, harvesting is continuing under favourable conditions.

Soybeans

In the **US**, conditions are favourable to exceptional as harvesting is well underway with record yields expected across much of the country. In **Canada**, harvest is beginning under generally favourable conditions; however, yields and crop quality may be impacted by recent frosts in Manitoba. In **China**, conditions are favourable as harvesting continues. In **India**, harvesting has begun under favourable conditions. Sown area is higher this year than the average and last year's levels. In **Ukraine**, harvest is ongoing under mixed conditions due to the severe summer drought, particularly in the southern and central regions.

Information on crop conditions in non-AMIS countries can be found in the [GEOGLAM Early Warning Crop Monitor](#), published 8 October 2020

Sources and Disclaimers: The Crop Monitor assessment is conducted by GEOGLAM with inputs from the following partners (in alphabetical order): Argentina (Buenos Aires Grains Exchange, MAGyP), Asia Rice Countries (AFSIS, ASEAN+3 & Asia RiCE), Australia (ABARES & CSIRO), Brazil (CONAB & INPE), Canada (AAFC), China (CAS), EU (EC JRC MARS), Indonesia (LAPAN & MOA), International (CIMMYT, FAO, IFPRI & IIRRI), Japan (JAXA), Mexico (SIAP), Russian Federation (IKI), South Africa (ARC & GeoTerraImage & SANSA), Thailand (GISTDA & OAE), Ukraine (NASU-NSAU & UHMC), USA (NASA, UMD, USGS – FEWS NET, USDA (FAS, NASS)), Viet Nam (VAST & VIMHE-MARD). The findings and conclusions in this joint multiagency report are consensual statements from the GEOGLAM experts, and do not necessarily reflect those of the individual agencies represented by these experts. More detailed information on the GEOGLAM crop assessments is available at www.geoglam-crop-monitor.org

Policy developments

Wheat

- On 21 September, **Egypt** notified the WTO of the adoption of the National Food Safety Authority (NFSA) Regulation No. 2/2020 (G/TBT/N/EGY/269), which organizes the registration requirements and procedures, enforcement, technical and financial obligations of the Conformity Assessment Bodies required to conduct valid pre-shipment inspection. The regulation covers various products, including wheat.
- On 21 September, **India** approved the increase in the minimum support prices (MSPs) for all mandated Rabi crops for marketing season 2021/22. The wheat MSP was increased by INR 50 to INR 1 975 per quintal (USD 267.6 per tonne).
- On 21 September, **the Philippines** extended for three years the anti-dumping duty imposed on Turkish wheat flour imports which was in place from January 2015 to January 2020.

Maize

- On 17 September, **Brazil** notified the WTO of the adoption of maximum residue limits (MRLs) for the pesticide glyphosate (G/SPS/N/BRA/1698/Add.1) applicable to GMO maize.
- On 23 September, **Canada** notified the WTO of proposed changes to MRLs on mandestrobin (G/SPS/N/CAN/1338) applicable to a variety of crops including maize, popcorn grain and sweetcorn kernels.

Rice

- On 9 September, **Brazil** announced that it will suspend import duties on a quota of 400 000 tonnes of paddy and milled (or semi-milled) rice from outside the Mercosur area until 31 December.
- On 9 September 2020, the **European Commission** implemented an import duty of EUR 65 (USD 76) per tonne for husked rice falling under CN code 1006 20, other than basmati rice, an increase of EUR 22.5 (USD 26.3) per tonne. This Regulation (EU) 2020/1259 was published on 8 September 2020 and repeals Regulation (EU) 2020/383.
- On 15 September, **Viet Nam** allocated VND 274 billion (USD 11.8 million) from the central budget's reserves to replenish national rice reserves.

Soybeans

- On 2 October, **Argentina** announced a temporary reduction in export taxes for soybeans, soymeal and soy oil in an attempt to boost exports. Soybean export taxes will be reduced by 3 percentage-points to 30 percent in an attempt to boost exports, while soy oil and soymeal export taxes will be reduced from 33 percent to 28 percent in October. All rates are planned to rise incrementally again until January 2021.
- On 17 September, **Brazil** notified the WTO of the adoption of MRLs on pesticides atrazine (G/SPS/N/BRA/1693/Add.1), mesotrione (G/SPS/N/BRA/1694/Add.1) and fluquinconazole (G/SPS/N/BRA/1695/Add.1) applicable to several products including soy cultures.

Biofuels

- On 1 September, **Brazil** reinstated a 20 percent tariff on US Ethanol imports, following the expiration of a one-year exemption from import duties for up to 750 million tonnes. On 11 September, Brazil announced that it will re-establish the duty-free imports at a pro-rata tariff-rate quota (TRQ) for ethanol proportional to the total annual volume of the TRQ that was in force on 30 August. This TRQ shall be in place from 14 September over a 90-day period whilst Brazil and the US partake in bilateral discussions regarding trade in ethanol.

Across the board

- On 4 September, **Brazil** updated the WTO with an Ad Hoc report on measures taken in relation to COVID-19 to assist the agricultural sector and vulnerable groups. The report covers measures adopted by Brazil as of 29 July (G/AG/GEN/165).
- On 1 September, **Canada** notified the WTO of the adoption of new MRLs for bixafen (G/SPS/N/CAN/1309/Add.1) applicable to several crops including soy, sorghum and cereal grains.
- On 4 September, **China** allocated CNY 400 million (USD 58.4 million) to a disaster relief fund to support agricultural production in flood-hit regions. The fund will be used in seven regions, including the provinces of Anhui and Sichuan, as well as the Chongqing municipality.
- On 9 September, **Egypt** announced the creation of a commodities exchange for several products, including wheat and rice. The commodities exchange will begin in the first half of 2021 and it was established in order to



AMIS Policy database

Visit the AMIS Policy database at: <http://statistics.amis-outlook.org/policy/>

The AMIS Policy database gathers information on trade measures and domestic measures related to the four AMIS crops (wheat, maize, rice, and soybeans) as well as biofuels. The design of this database allows comparisons across countries, across commodities and across policies for selected periods of time.

Only AMIS participants are marked in **bold**.

provide protection for small farmers and producers, alongside making their stocks available to the wider market.

- On 20 September, the **Indian** Parliament passed “the Farmers’ Produce Trade and Commerce (Promotion and Facilitation) Bill, 2020”, and “the Farmers’ (Empowerment and Protection) Agreement on Price Assurance and Farm Services Bill, 2020”. The first bill covers agricultural market reforms and the second contract farming provisions. One of the main provisions of the former bill is that it allows farmers to sell their produce at other places in addition to the government-regulated wholesale markets (mandis). A main provision of the latter bill is that it allows farmers to directly engage with processors, wholesalers, large retailers and exporters. In September, India also passed the Essential Commodities (Amendment) Bill, which removes limits on stockholding of several commodities, including cereals and oilseeds.
- On 4 September, the **Philippines** approved a stimulus package (Republic Act No. 11494), which aims to ease the economic hardship caused to businesses as a result of the COVID 19 pandemic. Under this Act, direct cash subsidies, zero-interest loans, and other forms of assistance will be provided to qualified farmers under the farmers’ registry and farmers’ cooperatives and associations. In addition, the Act allows a one-time 60-day grace period for paying loans, including credit card payments.
- On 2 September, the **US** notified the WTO of the establishment of new MRLs for pesticide Inpyrfluxam (G/SPS/N/USA/3199) used on several products including a number of maize varieties such as maize, popcorn grain and sweetcorn, rice and soybean.
- On 17 September, the **US** notified the WTO of the establishment of MRLs for pesticide Tiafenacil (G/SPS/N/USA/3201) used on a number of products including several varieties of corn, wheat and soybean.
- On 18 September, the **US** President and US Secretary of Agriculture announced up to an additional USD 14 billion for agricultural producers as a part of their extended Coronavirus Food Assistance Program (CFAP 2). Sign up for the CFAP 2 will begin 21 September and end 11 December. CFAP 2 payments will be made for several commodities, including maize, rice, soybeans and wheat.
- On 16 September, the **US** formally entered into consultations with **China** (WT/DS587/2) regarding the imposition of tariffs on certain goods originating from China by the US.

Logistic and Trade Juncture

- On 28 September, a 24 hours strike of cargo inspectors in Argentina disrupted the loading of grains ships at docks operated by major export companies in the country’s main shipping hub of Rosario.

Stop - press

- On 26 August, the **Russian Federation** approved a measure subsidizing transport carriers transiting through the country. Subsidies will vary from between RUB 25 000 and RUB 77 000 (USD 314.2 – USD 967.9) depending on the type and destination of the transit cargo. The new measure covers transit routes between ports on the Pacific Ocean or Baltic and Black seas, as well as checkpoints on the border with Finland, Belarus, Poland and Azerbaijan. The measure aims to increase the demand for freight transportation and improve the transit links between Europe and Asia.

International prices

International Grains Council (IGC) Grains and Oilseeds Index (GOI) and GOI sub-Indices

	Sep 2020 Average*	% Change M/M	% Change Y/Y
GOI	215	+ 7.8 %	+ 17.2 %
Wheat	195	+ 6.0 %	+ 11.9 %
Maize	198	+ 9.9 %	+ 21.5 %
Rice	188	+ 0.6 %	+ 16.1 %
Soybeans	212	+ 10.5 %	+ 20.3 %

*Jan 2000=100, derived from daily export quotations

Wheat

On average, world wheat export prices rallied by 6 percent during September, to their highest since January. Much of the impetus for price gains came from accelerating export interest, helping to calm uncertainty about demand during the COVID-19 pandemic. Price advances were also partly in response to gains in row crops as US maize/soy harvest prospects receded and China remained a heavy buyer. Uncertainty about production potential in Argentina provided sustained support, even though the overall outlook for world supplies was generally considered comfortable. Bullishly interpreted US production and stocks data contributed to a late-month rally. Increasing attention was given to adversely dry sowing conditions for 2021/22 winter wheat in Europe, the Black Sea region and the US, although fears were partly allayed by beneficial rains in some areas in the latter part of the month.

Maize

Global maize export prices spiked higher in September, the IGC GOI sub-Index rallying by an average of 10 percent, to a 28-month peak. Owing to downgraded Midwest production expectations, tightening port logistics, sustained Chinese buying interest and smaller than anticipated stocks, gains in US quotations were especially marked. FOB values in Argentina were similarly strong, as exporters looked to secure supplies to cover a busy shipping programme. Concerns about dry planting weather also underpinned. Brazil's maize market firmed on solid overseas and domestic demand, as well as occasionally reluctant farmer selling and

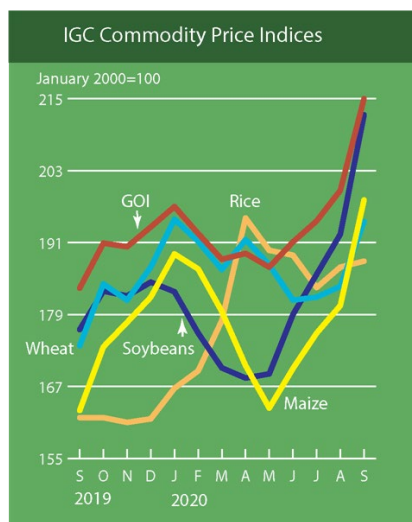
early sowing delays. Markets in Ukraine rose following recent damaging cropping weather and forecasts for a smaller export surplus.

Rice

Despite some weakness at Asian origins amid slow demand ahead of main crop arrivals, average international rice prices were fractionally stronger in September, led by gains in South America where tight supplies in Brazil underpinned. Average Thai quotes were also mildly higher on tight nearby availabilities, albeit with quotes softening throughout September on subdued buying interest as buyers awaited the onset of the 2020/21 harvest. Vietnamese values were weaker on slow demand, while prospects for another bumper crop also weighed on Indian offers.

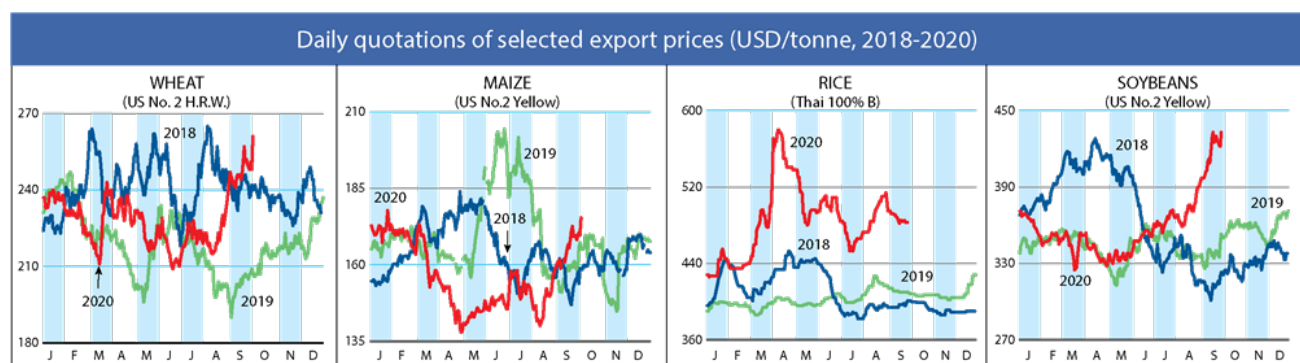
Soybeans

World soybean export prices advanced strongly during September, the IGC GOI sub-Index rising by 11 percent. US gains were underpinned by heightened worries about Midwest yield potential following a lengthy period of dry weather, smaller than anticipated US stocks, strong international demand – principally from China – and tightening port loading capacity. Old crop values in Brazil (Paranagua) were also significantly higher as availabilities dwindled after a season of record export volumes, while Up-River FOB prices in Argentina were firmer, in large part due to reluctant farmer sales against the backdrop of economic uncertainties.



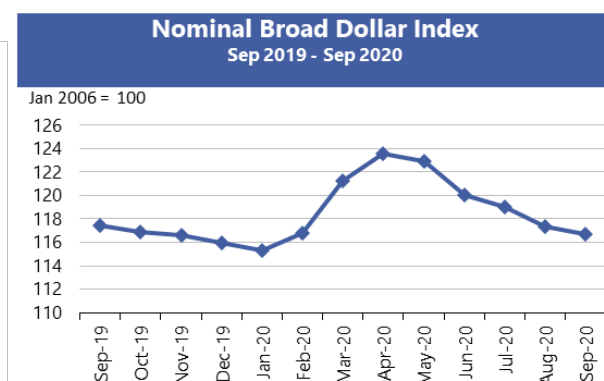
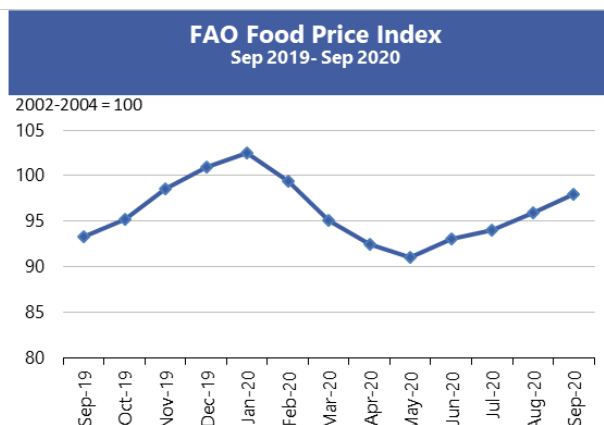
		IGC commodity price indices				
		GOI	Wheat	Maize	Rice	Soybeans
		(..... January 2000 = 100))				
2019	September	183.4	173.8	163.0	161.8	176.5
	October	190.9	184.1	173.6	161.8	182.9
	November	190.3	181.4	177.7	161.0	182.1
	December	193.6	186.9	181.9	161.6	184.4
2020	January	197.0	194.9	189.1	166.7	182.8
	February	192.5	191.2	186.6	169.6	175.9
	March	188.2	186.5	179.5	178.0	170.1
	April	189.2	191.5	170.5	195.1	168.4
	May	186.9	187.3	163.4	189.7	169.1
	June	191.1	181.4	170.0	188.9	179.0
	July	194.6	181.9	175.9	183.5	185.7
	August	199.7	183.7	180.5	186.9	192.4
	September	215.0	194.5	198.1	187.9	212.3

Selected export prices, currencies and indices



Daily quotations of selected export prices						
	Effective Date	Quotation (1)	Month ago (2)	Year ago (3)	% change (1) over (2)	% change (1) over (3)
..... USD/tonne						
Wheat (US No. 2, HRW)	30-Sep	261	243	209	7.4%	24.9%
Maize (US No. 2, Yellow)	30-Sep	175	161	166	9.2%	5.9%
Rice (Thai 100% B)	30-Sep	483	510	410	-5.3%	17.8%
Soybeans (US No. 2, Yellow)	30-Sep	433	390	346	11.0%	25.1%

AMIS Countries' Currencies Against US Dollar				
AMIS Countries	Currency	Sep2020 Average	Monthly Change	Annual Change
Argentina	ARS	75.1	-2.6%	-33.0%
Australia	AUD	1.4	0.3%	5.7%
Brazil	BRL	5.4	1.1%	-31.1%
Canada	CAD	1.3	0.0%	0.1%
China	CNY	6.8	1.7%	4.3%
Egypt	EGP	15.7	1.0%	3.7%
EU	EUR	0.8	-0.4%	6.6%
India	INR	73.5	1.4%	-3.1%
Indonesia	IDR	14,784.5	-0.9%	-4.9%
Japan	JPY	105.6	0.4%	1.8%
Kazakhstan	KZT	425.1	-1.3%	-9.8%
Rep. Korea	KRW	1,177.5	0.7%	1.4%
Mexico	MXN	21.7	2.3%	-10.6%
Nigeria	NGN	380.7	0.0%	-24.4%
Philippines	PHP	48.5	0.5%	6.8%
Russian Fed.	RUB	76.0	-3.1%	-17.0%
Saudi Arabia	SAR	3.8	0.0%	0.0%
South Africa	ZAR	16.7	3.0%	-12.7%
Thailand	THB	31.4	-0.5%	-2.6%
Turkey	TRY	7.6	-3.8%	-32.4%
UK	GBP	0.8	-1.4%	4.6%
Ukraine	UAH	28.0	-1.9%	-13.4%
Viet Nam	VND	23,177.9	0.0%	0.1%



Source: US Federal Reserve

Futures market (US)

Futures Prices – nearby

	Sep-20 Average	% Change	
		M/M	Y/Y
Wheat	202	6.7%	14.5%
Maize	143	11.4%	0.1%
Rice	273	3.8%	3.5%
Soybeans	367	10.4%	13.8%

Source: CME

Historical Volatility – 30 Days, nearby

	Monthly Averages		
	Sep-20	Aug-20	Sep-19
Wheat	24.4	28.7	27.5
Maize	20.7	23.8	30.1
Rice	21.2	77.4	17.4
Soybeans	15.9	12.9	17.4

Futures Prices

Futures prices for wheat, maize, soybeans and rice rose m/m as US exports rebounded and crop conditions deteriorated, particularly for maize. The USDA lowered its 2020/21 maize and soybean crop estimates m/m, while several private forecasters projected further drops to overall yields and harvested acres, citing regional yield variability and wind damage in the largest producing state of Iowa. US exports to China, which had been trailing for months, expanded under the US sales registry to record levels for both maize and soybeans for this time of year, while sales to “unknown” destination also increased dramatically. The uncertainty in domestic demand due to COVID-19 largely dissipated during the month, although ethanol production (consuming approximately one-third of the US maize crop) was estimated to remain below last year’s levels. With respect to exogenous markets, the US dollar index, which had dropped to a two-year low in August, rebounded above key technical levels – tempering some of the monthly gains in cereal/oilseed prices by month end. Prices for wheat, maize, soybeans and rice were 14.5, 0.1, 13.8 and 3.5 percent higher respectively. A surprise USDA third quarter stocks report - showing wheat, maize and soybean levels below trade estimates - boosted prices on the final day of September.

Volumes and volatility

Trade volumes for wheat and maize fell m/m but rose for soybeans as China purchased large export quantities of the oilseed. Volumes declined y/y for maize while increasing for both wheat and soybeans. Historical volatility dipped slightly for wheat and maize m/m, rose marginally for soybeans, while implied volatility increased m/m for all three commodities. In rice, implied and historical volatility - which had reached historic levels during July and August, when domestic supplies became scarce - returned to normal levels.

Basis levels and transport

Domestic basis levels declined m/m for maize and soybeans, as harvest was commencing in the southern regions. In Illinois, average quotes to local elevators were

minus USD 8 per tonne for maize, and minus USD 11 per tonne for soybeans, each under the respective December and November futures prices. In Iowa, maize and soybean bids were minus USD 12 and minus USD 21 respectively (under the respective futures). Soft red wheat bids for delivery to northern flour mills were quoted at small discounts and premiums to December futures. Maize and soybean bids delivered to gulf were about unchanged m/m at USD 21 and USD 28 respectively despite the recent surge of export sales. Soft red wheat values were quoted at around USD 20 (per tonne premiums over respective September futures). Barge traffic remains closed for the Lower Illinois River while the Army Corps of Engineers completed repairs to four of its locks and dams. The River is scheduled to reopen during late October or early November – the peak harvest period when producers and warehouses rely heavily on barge shipments to the Gulf export market. The USDA reported that export sales commitments for maize and soybeans were experiencing a sharp rebound - more than doubling y/y. Wheat export sales also surpassed the previous year.

Forward curves

Forward curves for wheat were about unchanged while those for maize tightened in nearby months following the spate of export sales. Forward curves for soybeans displayed a dramatic move from contango (upward sloping) to backwardation (downward sloping) for the y/y November 2020/November 2021 calendar spread, reflecting the sudden and unprecedented surge in exports sales together with lowered USDA estimates of ending stocks/usage of around 10 percent.

Investment flows

Managed money reduced its small net short for wheat, reversed its net short in maize to a moderate net long, while increasing its net long for soybeans m/m. Commercials maintained their standard net short positions in wheat while sharply increasing their net shorts in soybeans and maize, as prices rose.



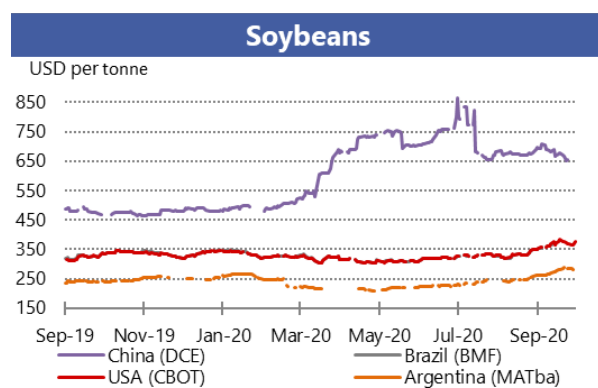
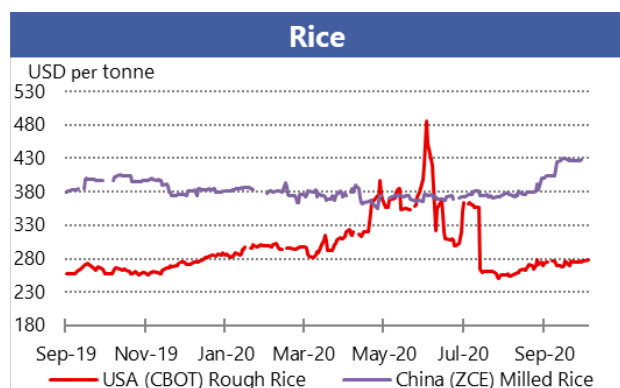
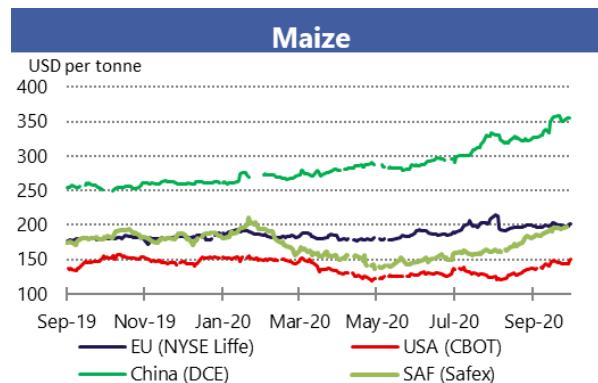
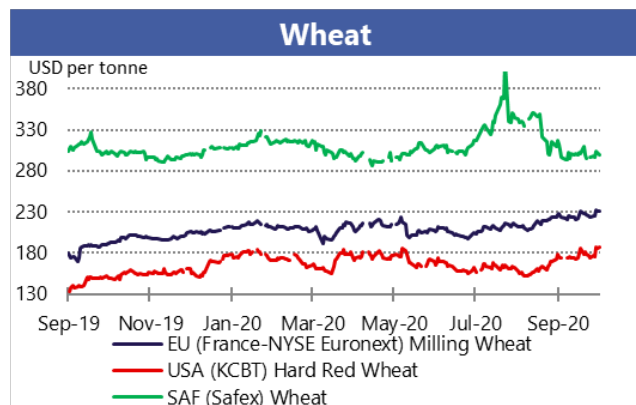
AMIS Market indicators

Some of the indicators covered in this report are updated regularly on the AMIS website. These, as well as other market indicators, can be found at: <http://www.amis-outlook.org/amis-monitoring/indicators/>

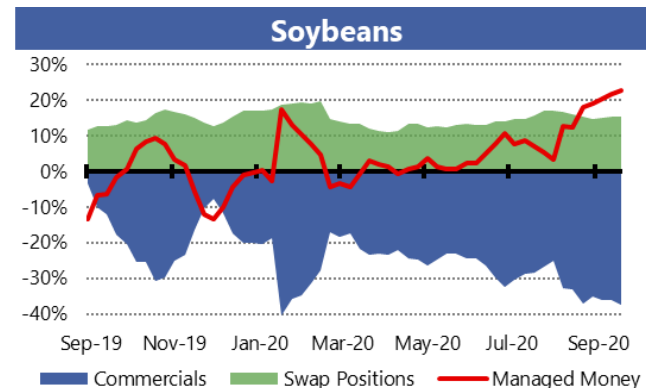
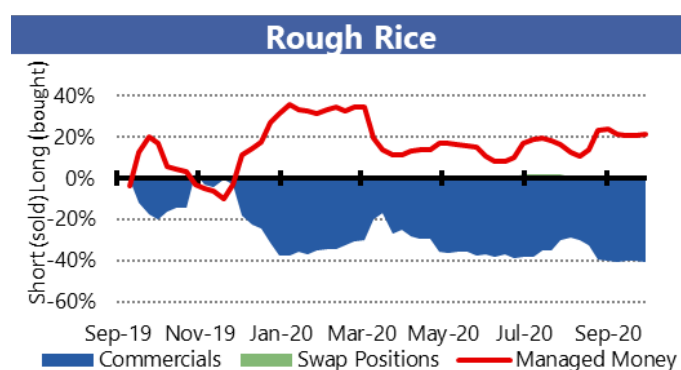
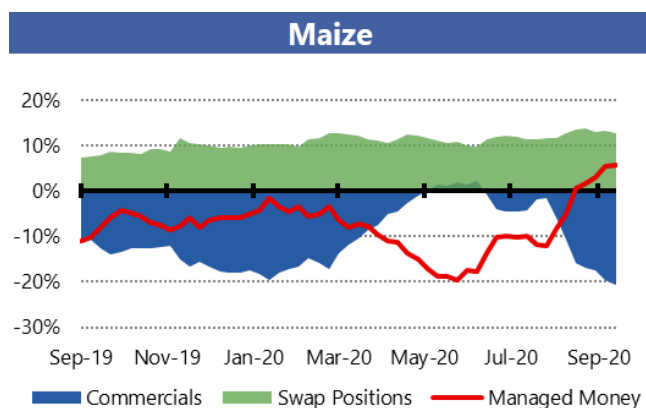
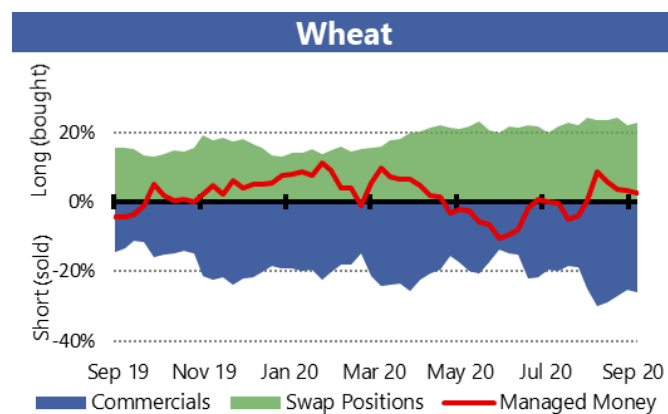
*For more information about Forward Curves see the feature article in [No. 75 February AMIS Market Monitor 2020](#).

Market indicators

Daily quotations from leading exchanges - nearby futures

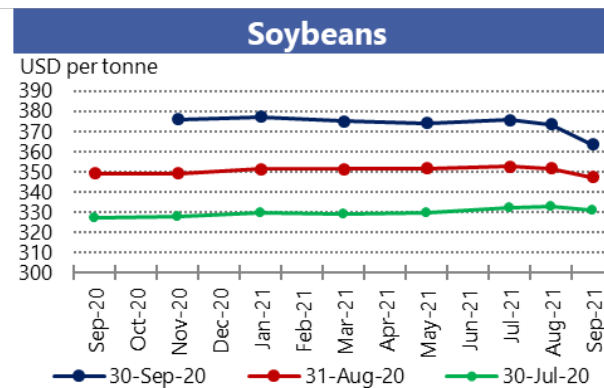
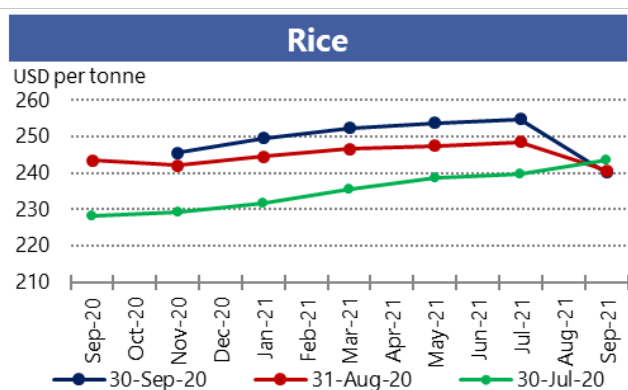
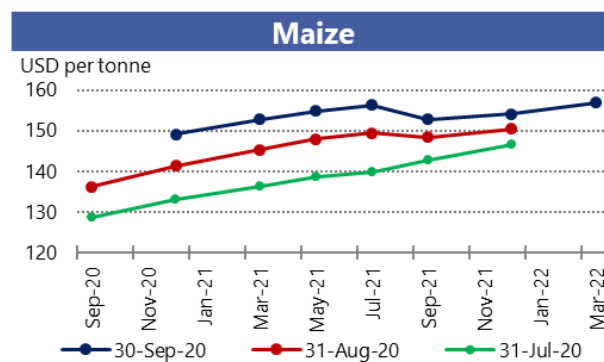
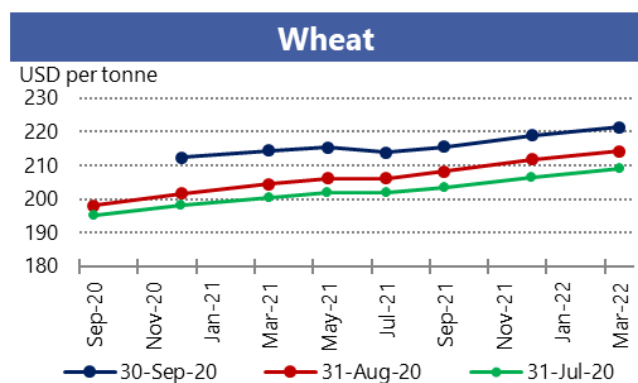


CFTC Commitments of Traders - Major Categories Net Length as percentage of Open Interest*

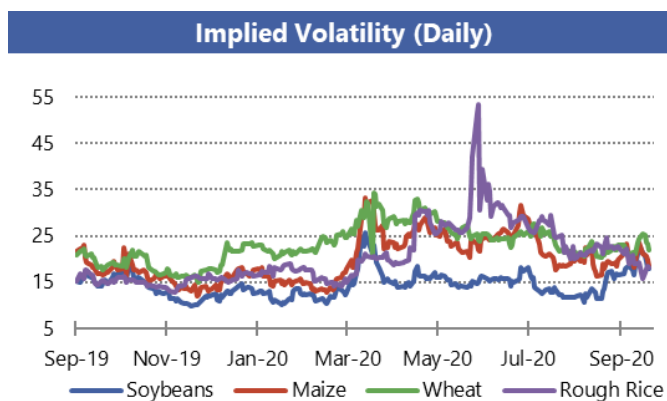
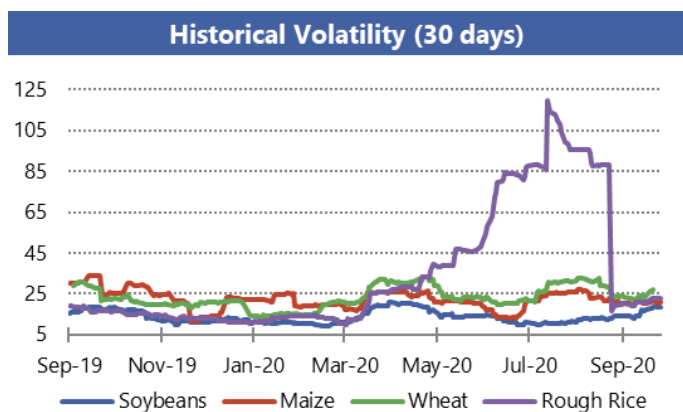


*Disaggregated Futures Only. Though not all positions are reflected in the charts, total long positions always equal total short positions.

Forward Curves

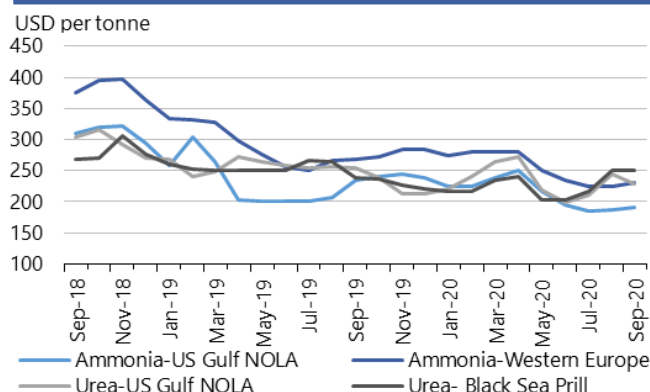


Historical and Implied Volatilities

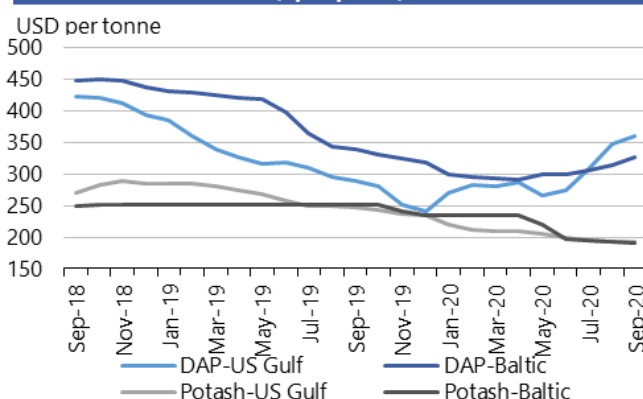


Fertilizer outlook

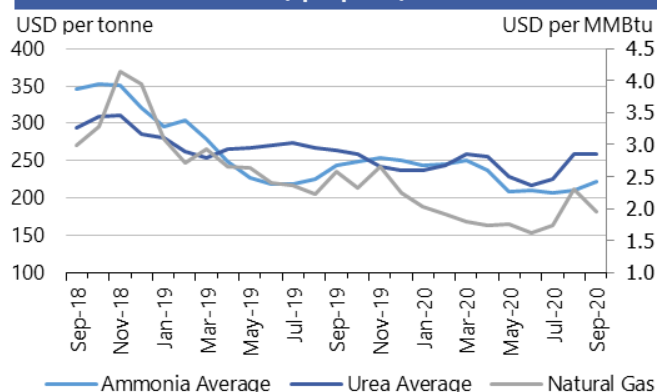
Ammonia and Urea
(Spot prices)



Potash and Phosphate
(Spot prices)



Ammonia Average, Urea Average and Natural Gas
(Spot prices)



Note: Natural gas is used as major input to produce nitrogen-based fertilizers.
Own elaboration based on Bloomberg.

- **Natural gas prices** ended their two-month recovery, dropping 15 percent during September due to a buildup in US inventories.
- Despite lower gas prices, **ammonia** prices increased 2 percent m/m given production shortages in the Northern Hemisphere.
- **Urea prices** decreased 6 percent m/m in the US Gulf due to the (end of season) drop in demand, while they remained constant in the Black Sea and slightly increased in other regions.
- Supply disruptions in North Africa continue to put upward pressure on **DAP** prices; in the US Gulf, prices reached almost 25 percent above one year ago levels.
- **Potash** prices were relatively flat in September despite a reduced need for fertilizer application in the Northern Hemisphere.

	September average	September std. dev	% change last month*	% change last year*	12-month high	12-month low
Ammonia-US Gulf NOLA	192.0	-	2.4%	-18.3%	250.0	186.0
Ammonia-Western Europe	230.3	3.5	2.3%	-14.3%	285.0	225.0
Urea-US Gulf	229.5	2.6	-6.0%	-9.9%	272.8	199.5
Urea-Black Sea	251.0	6.9	0.3%	5.0%	251.0	203.0
DAP-US Gulf	361.3	2.5	3.6%	24.8%	361.3	241.0
DAP-Baltic	326.5	10.8	3.7%	-3.6%	331.0	291.0
Potash-Baltic	190.5	0.6	-1.0%	-24.4%	251.5	191.0
Potash- US Gulf NOLA	193.8	2.5	0.3%	-21.9%	242.3	193.0
Ammonia	222.3	2.4	5.5%	-8.8%	254.0	206.5
Urea	259.1	2.8	0.2%	-2.0%	259.1	217.0
Natural Gas	2.0	0.3	-15.2%	-24.4%	2.7	1.6

All prices shown are in US dollars.

Source: Own elaboration based on Bloomberg



Chart and tables description * Estimated using available weekly data to date.

Ammonia and Urea: Overview of nitrogen-based fertilizer prices in the US Gulf, Western Europe and Black Sea. Prices are weekly prices averaged by month.

Potash and Phosphate: Overview of phosphate and potassium-based fertilizer prices in the US Gulf, Baltic and Vancouver. Prices are weekly prices averaged by month.

Ammonia Average and Urea Average: Monthly average prices from Ammonia's US Gulf NOLA, Middle East, Black Sea and Western Europe were averaged to obtain Ammonia Average prices; monthly average prices from Urea's US Gulf NOLA, US Gulf Prill, Middle East Prill, Black Sea Prill and Mediterranean were averaged to obtain Urea Average prices.

Natural Gas: Henry Hub Natural Gas Spot Price from ICE up to December 2017 and from Bloomberg (BGAP) from January 2018 onwards. Prices are intraday prices averaged by month. Natural gas is used as major input to produce nitrogen-based fertilizers

DAP: Diammonium Phosphate.

Ocean freight markets

Dry bulk freight market developments

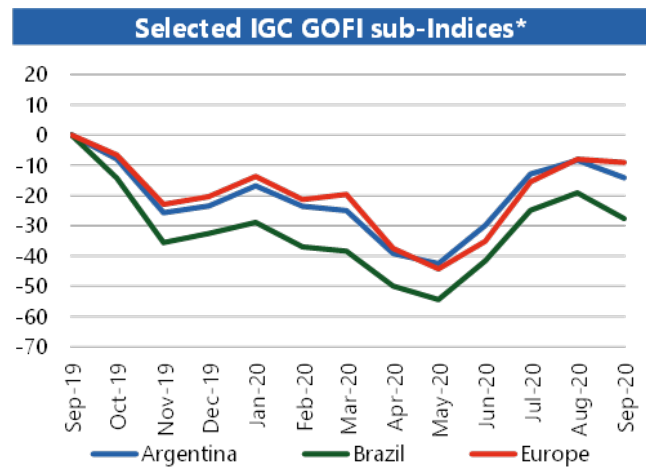
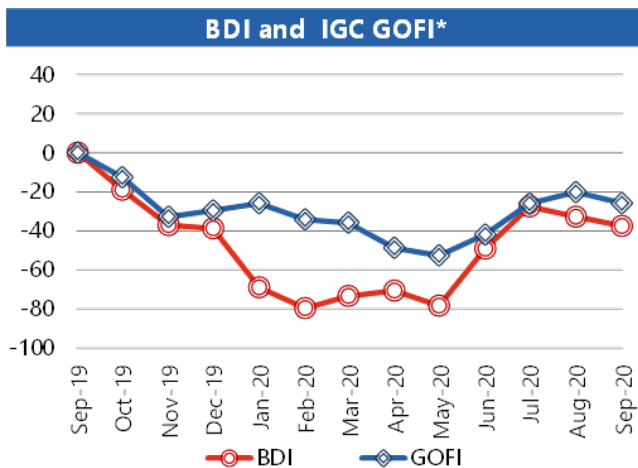
	September-20 average	Change m/m	Change y/y
Baltic Dry Index (BDI)*	1410.8	-6.9%	-37.4%
<i>sub-Indices:</i>			
Capesize	2179.1	-6.7%	-50.0%
Panamax	1383.6	-14.9%	-33.4%
Supramax	952.5	+4.1%	-27.1%
Baltic Handysize Index (BHSI)**	568.8	+11.5%	-17.4%

Sources: Baltic Exchange, IGC.

*4 January 1985 = 1000. **23 May 2006 = 1000.

***1 January 2013 = 100.

	September-20 average	Change m/m	Change y/y
IGC Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI)***	114.2	-7.2%	-25.9%
<i>sub-Indices:</i>			
Argentina	142.1	-6.3%	-14.1%
Australia	75.3	-4.2%	-19.9%
Brazil	147.5	-10.6%	-27.6%
Black Sea	118.5	-6.0%	-37.7%
Canada	95.8	-5.7%	-24.6%
Europe	101.1	-1.2%	-9.1%
US	96.3	-5.6%	-23.9%



*percentage change based on monthly average values

- The dry bulk complex displayed mixed trends in constituent segments during September, while market volatility remained relatively low, including in the Capesize sector. Despite the recent upswing, the **Baltic Dry Index (BDI)** averaged 7 percent lower compared to August. While earnings across all sectors are markedly lower compared to the prior year, vessel owners still anticipate a pick-up in activity during the fourth quarter.
- The **Capesize** Baltic sub-Index was down by 7 percent m/m on average. Values initially receded against the backdrop of reduced iron ore fixing, but subsequently rebounded on an upturn in fronthaul rates from key origins and interest for transatlantic round voyages. Strong import data for China likely offered support, with iron ore arrivals during the first eight months of 2020 up by 11 percent y/y, boosted by large deliveries in June-August.
- Average **Panamax** earnings posted a 15 percent monthly drop. Rising tonnage availability in the Atlantic contributed to initial losses, even though strong grains/oilseeds activity

was noted out of South America and the US Gulf, with the vessel line-up in the latter area reportedly reaching an eight-year peak. Rates edged up more recently, buoyed by increased enquiries in the northern Atlantic and fresh business out of the northern Pacific.

- Trends in **Supramax** and **Handysize** sectors were likewise two-sided, albeit with corresponding Baltic Indices up m/m. Sustained activity was noted in many areas, including South America, the US Gulf, Europe and the Black Sea region, while an uptick in demand for wheat shipments from Australia offered more recent support in the Pacific.
- Lower bunker prices contributed to weaker freight rates across the main grains/oilseeds origins, reflected in a 7 percent m/m drop in the IGC **Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI)**. Also linked to weaker timecharter values, the sub-Index for Brazil – mainly Panamax-based – posted the largest drop, while mostly Supramax/Handysize-centred rates in Europe recorded relatively small losses.



Source: International Grains Council

Baltic Dry Index (BDI): A benchmark indicator issued daily by the Baltic Exchange, providing assessed costs of moving raw materials on ocean going vessels. Comprises sub-Indices for three segments: Capesize, Panamax and Supramax. The Baltic Handysize Index excluded from the BDI from 1 March 2018.

IGC Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI): A trade-weighted composite measure of ocean freight costs for grains and oilseeds, issued daily by the International Grains Council. Includes sub-Indices for seven main origins (Argentina, Australia, Brazil, Black Sea, Canada, the EU and the USA). Constructed based on nominal HSS (heavy grains, soybeans, sorghum) voyage rates on selected major routes.

Capesize: Vessels with deadweight tonnage (DWT) above 80,000 DWT, primarily transporting coal, iron ore and other heavy raw materials on long-haul routes.

Panamax: Carriers with capacity of 60,000-80,000 DWT, mostly geared to transporting coal, grains, oilseeds and other bulks, including sugar and cement.

Supramax/Handysize: Ships with capacity below 60,000 DWT, accounting for the majority of the world's ocean-going vessels and able to transport a wide variety of cargos, including grains and oilseeds.

Explanatory notes

The notions of **tightening** and **easing** used in the summary table of “Markets at a glance” reflect judgmental views that take into account market fundamentals, inter-alia price developments and short-term trends in demand and supply, especially changes in stocks.

All totals (aggregates) are computed from unrounded data. World supply and demand estimates/forecasts are based on the latest data published by FAO, IGC and USDA. For the former, they also take into account information provided by AMIS focal points (hence the notion “FAO-AMIS”). World estimates and forecasts produced by the three sources may vary due to several reasons, such as varying release dates and different methodologies used in constructing commodity balances. Specifically:

Production: Wheat production data from all three sources refer to production occurring in the first year of the marketing season shown (e.g. crops harvested in 2016 are allocated to the 2016/17 marketing season). Maize and rice production data for FAO-AMIS refer to crops harvested during the first year of the marketing season (e.g. 2016 for the 2016/17 marketing season) in both the northern and southern hemisphere. Rice production data for FAO-AMIS also include northern hemisphere production from secondary crops harvested in the second year of the marketing season (e.g. 2017 for the 2016/17 marketing season). By contrast, rice and maize data for USDA and IGC encompass production in the northern hemisphere occurring during the first year of the season (e.g. 2016 for the 2016/17 marketing season), as well as crops harvested in the southern hemisphere during the second year of the season (e.g. 2017 for the 2016/17 marketing season). For soybeans, the latter approach is used by all three sources.

Supply: Defined as production plus opening stocks by all three sources.

Utilization: For all three sources, wheat, maize and rice utilization includes food, feed and other uses (namely, seeds, industrial uses and post-harvest losses). For soybeans, it comprises crush, food and other uses. However, for all AMIS commodities, the use categories may be grouped differently across sources and may also include residual values.

Trade: Data refer to exports. For wheat and maize, trade is reported on a July/June basis, except for USDA maize trade estimates, which are reported on an October/September basis. Wheat trade data from all three sources includes wheat flour in wheat grain equivalent, while the USDA also considers wheat products. For rice, trade covers shipments from January to December of the second year of the respective marketing season. For soybeans, trade is reported on an October/September basis by FAO-AMIS and the IGC, while USDA data are based on local marketing years except for Argentina and Brazil which are reported on an October/September basis. Trade between European Union member states is excluded.

Stocks: In general, world stocks of AMIS crops refer to the sum of carry-overs at the close of each country's national marketing year. For soybeans, stock levels reported by the USDA are based on local marketing years, except for Argentina and Brazil, which are adjusted to October/September. For maize and rice, global estimates may vary across sources because of differences in the allocation of production in southern hemisphere countries.

For more information on AMIS Supply and Demand, please view [AMIS Supply and Demand Balances Manual](#).

Main sources

Bloomberg, CFTC, CME Group, FAO, GEOGLAM, IFPRI, IGC, Reuters, USDA, US Federal Reserve

AMIS - GEOGLAM Crop Calendar

Selected leading producers

Wheat		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
EU (21%)*	winter												
China (17%)	spring												
	winter												
India (13%)	winter												
US (8%)	spring												
	winter												
Russia (8%)	spring												
	winter												
Maize		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
US (35%)													
China (22%)	north												
	south												
Brazil (8%)	1st crop												
	2nd crop												
EU (7%)													
Argentina (3%)													
Rice		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
China (29%)	intermediary crop												
	late crop												
	early crop												
India (21%)	kharif												
	rabi												
Indonesia (9%)	main Java												
	second Java												
Viet Nam (6%)	winter-spring												
	summer/autumn												
	winter												
Thailand (4%)	main season												
	second season												
Soybeans		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
USA (31%)													
Brazil (29%)													
Argentina (18%)													
China (4%)													
India (3%)													

* Percentages refer to the global share of production (average 2013-15).

	Planting (peak)		Harvest (peak)
	Planting		Harvest
	Weather conditions in this period are critical for yields.		Growing period

2020 AMIS Market Monitor Release Dates

February 6, March 5, April 2, May 7, June 4, July 2, September 3, October 8, November 5, December 3

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